■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Friday, September 18, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *World’s first large-scale, green hydrogen-based steel plant can cut emissions by up to 95%*

The Angle: *Steelmaking is one of the dirtiest industries on Earth, and this plant claims it can gut emissions by up to 95% by swapping coal for hydrogen — a huge deal for climate tech and for every industry that buys steel.*

- Billed as the **world's first large-scale** steel plant running on **green hydrogen**
- Claims it can slash emissions by **up to 95%** compared to traditional coal-fired steelmaking
- Steel production is one of the **biggest industrial carbon polluters** globally, so a viable green alternative is a milestone moment

The Debate Starter

- Is 'green steel' actually going to scale fast enough to matter, or is this a nice headline that stays a one-off pilot plant?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://interestingengineering.com/innovation/world-first-green-hydrogen-steel-plant

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■■ *Many Republicans want to lose the midterms so they don’t have to pass Trump-backed bills, Laura Ingraham claims*

The Angle: *Laura Ingraham is floating a wild insider theory - that some Republicans would rather tank the midterms than get stuck voting on Trump's agenda. It's the kind of inside-baseball conspiracy talk that turns into a real fight about whether politicians actually work for voters or just for themselves.*

- **Laura Ingraham**, one of **Fox News'** biggest primetime names, is the one pushing this claim - not a random pundit.
- Her theory: a chunk of **Republicans** secretly want to LOSE the **midterms** rather than win and be forced to pass **Trump-backed bills**.
- It paints sitting GOP lawmakers as more scared of tough votes than of losing their jobs.

The Debate Starter

- Would politicians really rather LOSE an election than take a hard vote - cynical genius or tinfoil hat?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.the-independent.com/news/world/americas/us-politics/trump-republicans-midterms-laura-ingraham-b3052487.html

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■ *Donald Trump Says He’s Banning CNN, MS NOW and Politico From the White House ‘Effective Immediately’ as a Result of ‘Their Constant Fake News’*

The Angle: *This is a president openly barring specific news outlets from the briefing room over coverage he doesn't like — a press freedom flashpoint that's got media watchdogs, politicians, and social media all lit up at once.*

- **Donald Trump** says he's banning **CNN**, **MS NOW** (the network formerly known as MSNBC), and **Politico** from the White House "effective immediately"
- His stated reason: what he calls their "**constant fake news**" coverage
- All three outlets have long been frequent targets of Trump's media criticism

The Debate Starter

- Is this a president fighting back against biased coverage, or the government punishing reporters for doing their job — where do you land?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/donald-trump-ban-cnn-msnow-politico-from-white-house-fake-news-1236867138/

■ *Barbra Streisand torches Donald Trump and his 'unchecked ego' after Kennedy Center drama*

The Angle: *Barbra Streisand torches Donald Trump and his 'unchecked ego' after Kennedy Center drama*

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.irishstar.com/culture/entertainment/barbra-streisand-donald-trump-kennedy-37675243?utm_source=reddit&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=reddit

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■ *Trump bans CNN, MSNOW, and Politico from the White House*

The Angle: *A sitting president cutting off major newsrooms from White House access is a straight-up press freedom flashpoint, and it's the kind of story that splits a room fast between 'about time' and 'this is dangerous.'*

- **CNN**, **MSNOW**, and **Politico** have reportedly been banned from White House access under **Trump**
- It's the latest escalation in the administration's ongoing feud with mainstream media outlets
- Details on the specific reasoning behind the ban are still thin in early reports

The Debate Starter

- Is this a president finally pushing back on biased coverage, or the White House shutting the door on accountability?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://i.redd.it/353hzn2ivbqh1.jpeg

Backup options:

■ *Trump says deal struck to boost U.S. military presence in Greenland*

The Angle: *Trump says deal struck to boost U.S. military presence in Greenland*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/trump-deal-claim-greenland-denmark-security-9.7350385?cmp=rss

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■ *The National | Trump says Greenland's security now under U.S. control*

The Angle: *Trump claims Denmark just handed over 'permanent control' of Greenland's security to the US - after a year of him openly musing about annexing the island, this is either a huge geopolitical shift or a massive overstatement, and either way it's a story with real stakes for NATO and North America.*

- **Donald Trump** says **Denmark** has agreed to hand over **'permanent control'** of **Greenland's** security to the **U.S.**
- Comes after months of Trump publicly floating the idea of the **U.S. acquiring Greenland** outright
- Greenland is a **Danish territory** - and a **NATO ally's** land, which makes any handover claim a big deal diplomatically

The Debate Starter

- Is this a real deal or Trump just saying it's a deal - and either way, should the US be this openly eyeing another country's territory?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/player/play/9.4236164?cmp=rss

CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■ *Whistleblower says CIBC is replacing Canadians with cheap foreign labour*

The Angle: *This taps straight into the outsourcing/job security anxiety a lot of Canadians already feel, and it's a big bank accused of it - that's an easy debate to get two hosts and the phones going.*

- A whistleblower is alleging **CIBC** is replacing Canadian workers with **cheaper foreign labour**
- Claim surfaced on **r/Canada**, suggesting it's already getting grassroots traction online
- Limited detail available beyond the core allegation - no official CIBC response cited yet

The Debate Starter

- Should Canadian banks be required to prioritize Canadian jobs, or is this just how global business works now?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://wiretapmedia.ca/whistleblower-says-cibc-is-replacing-canadians-with-cheap-foreign-labour/

■■ *As Carney's popularity soars, Conservatives weigh what to do about their own leader*

The Angle: *As Prime Minister Mark Carney's popularity keeps climbing, whispers are growing inside the Conservative Party about whether their own leader can actually beat him — a classic 'panic button' political story that Canadian listeners on both sides will have opinions on.*

- **Mark Carney's** approval appears to be trending up as PM, per chatter out of **r/canada**.
- That surge is reportedly putting pressure on the **Conservative Party** to reassess its own leadership.
- Specific numbers and named sources aren't confirmed yet — this one's still developing.

The Debate Starter

- If you're a Conservative voter — is it time to cut your losses on leadership, or stick it out?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/poilievre-conservative-party-caucus-9.7348564

■ *Canadian investors ditched U.S. stocks at a record pace in July*

The Angle: *Cross-border money moves usually fly under the radar, but this one's a record — and it says a lot about how Canadians are feeling about the U.S. economy and the trade relationship right now.*

- **Canadian investors** pulled out of **U.S. stocks** at a **record pace** in **July**.
- The scale of the sell-off is what's turning heads — biggest pullback on record, not just a routine dip.

The Wallet Check

- Have you moved any of your own money out of U.S. investments lately — and what's driving that call?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theglobeandmail.com/business/article-canadian-investors-ditched-us-stocks-at-a-record-pace-in-july/

Backup options:

■ *F.B.I. Temporarily Halted Cooperation With Canada Over References to 9/11*

The Angle: *A rare rupture in US-Canada law enforcement ties is trending because it touches the most sensitive nerve in American politics - 9/11 - and signals just how frayed the relationship has gotten behind the scenes.*

- The **FBI** reportedly **temporarily halted cooperation** with Canadian authorities.
- The freeze was tied to **references to 9/11** made on the Canadian side.
- Full details are still thin - this is a developing story worth tracking for specifics on what exactly was said and by whom.

The Debate Starter

- Does this feel like a real diplomatic rift, or a headline-grabbing overreaction?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.nytimes.com/2026/09/18/us/politics/fbi-canada-cbc-9-11.html?smid=nytcore-android-share

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■ *RCMP says relationships with allies 'strong' after report FBI stopped co-operation following CBC 9/11 memo*

The Angle: *A leaked report claims the FBI paused cooperation with Canadian police over a CBC memo tied to 9/11 — and now the RCMP is publicly insisting everything's fine with its closest ally.*

- **RCMP** issued a statement calling its relationship with international allies **"strong"**
- The statement comes after a report claimed the **FBI** halted cooperation with Canadian authorities
- The dispute traces back to a **CBC** memo referencing **9/11**
- Full details on what the memo said and why it triggered the reported freeze remain unclear

The Debate Starter

- Is this a real diplomatic rift between Canada and the U.S., or damage control over a story that got overblown?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/cbc-9-11-memo-fbi-rcmp-new-york-times-9.7350004?cmp=rss

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■■ *Time zones in Canada are getting complicated. These maps lay them out*

The Angle: *Most people assume Canada has like four time zones — turns out it's way more complicated than that, with weird local offsets and half-hour quirks that trip up even Canadians. It's a fun, relatable "wait, what?" story that plays perfectly for a cross-country audience.*

The Phone-In Trigger

- Call in and tell us the most confusing time zone mix-up you've ever had trying to schedule something across Canada.

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Guess the Zone** - 60 seconds, cold open -> Name a small Canadian town and have the co-host guess its time zone before revealing the (probably wrong) answer.
- **Step 2: Newfoundland Time Roast** - Quick back-and-forth -> Riff on Canada's infamous half-hour time zone and ask listeners to defend or roast it.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/time-zone-canada-map-9.7349663?cmp=rss

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ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *Stop trying to sell us Chris Brown's redemption arc*

The Angle: *Every few months there's a fresh push to reframe Chris Brown as a misunderstood artist deserving a comeback narrative, and this piece is the latest pushback saying enough is enough - it's the kind of pop culture debate that splits a room fast.*

The Debate Starter

- Can - or should - an artist's history ever be fully separated from their art, no matter how much time passes?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.motherjones.com/media/2026/09/chris-brown-jasmine-crockett-epstein-abuse-congressional-honor/

■■ *Nicole ‘Snooki’ Polizzi Says She’s Cancer-Free 7 Months After Diagnosis: ‘I’m on the Other Side’*

The Angle: *A beloved reality TV name sharing a cancer battle and beating it is exactly the kind of good-news, human-interest story that gets an audience talking — relatable, emotional, and worth a happy update on air.*

- **Nicole 'Snooki' Polizzi** revealed she is now **cancer-free**

- The announcement comes **7 months** after her original diagnosis
- Her quote: **"I'm on the other side"**

The Feel-Good Moment

- Anyone else have a 'ringing the bell' moment in their family worth sharing on air?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://people.com/nicole-snooki-polizzi-says-she-is-cancer-free-exclusive-12127569?utm_campaign=peoplemagazine&utm_medium=social&utm_source=reddit.com&utm_content=post

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■ *When Kesha lost her case vs Dr Luke and contractually had to keep making albums under his label, Sony refused to promote her and she could only play small theaters. Macklemore invited her on a joint tour where they split stage time evenly, donating a portion of sales to SA victims & racial justice.*

The Angle: *This is the ultimate 'good guy in the music industry' story - while Kesha was contractually trapped and getting frozen out by her own label, another artist gave up half his spotlight and cash to back her. That kind of loyalty is rare in entertainment and it's a great water-cooler moment about industry ethics.*

- **Kesha** lost her legal case against **Dr. Luke**, leaving her contractually obligated to keep making albums under his label
- **Sony** reportedly refused to promote her music after the ruling
- She was relegated to playing small theaters instead of the big venues her career once had
- **Macklemore** invited her on a joint tour, splitting stage time evenly and donating a portion of sales to SA victims and racial justice causes

The Industry Loyalty Test

- Would you split your own spotlight - and your paycheck - to help a friend claw back a career the industry tried to bury?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kesha_v._Dr._Luke

■■ *Damon Albarn of Gorillaz holds up a Palestinian flag at their show last night in Orlando, FL: “Don’t forget this. Ever. Stand your position. Don’t ever be neutral”*

The Angle: *Damon Albarn just turned a Gorillaz show into a political flashpoint - artists wading into Israel-Palestine on stage always splits a crowd, and 'don't ever be neutral' is the kind of line that gets clipped and argued about online for days.*

- Happened at last night's **Gorillaz** show in **Orlando, FL**
- Frontman **Damon Albarn** held up a **Palestinian flag** on stage
- His exact quote to the crowd: **"Don't forget this. Ever. Stand your position. Don't ever be neutral"**
- Story is circulating out of **r/fauxmoi** on Reddit

The Debate Starter

- Should musicians use the stage to push political statements, or just play the hits?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/ovvjzbp6vbqh1

Backup options:

■ *In 1994, promoters told Green Day that they wouldn’t allow their opener Pansy Division, a queer punk band, to play. Green Day’s response was that if Pansy Division didn’t play, they wouldn’t play. The promoters backed down.*

The Angle: *This old story's making the rounds again because it's basically the blueprint for using your platform right — a massive band using their leverage to protect a queer opener instead of just staying quiet.*

- Back in **1994**, promoters tried to bar **Pansy Division**, an openly queer punk band, from opening for **Green Day**.
- **Green Day's** response: no **Pansy Division**, no **Green Day** — full stop.
- The promoters caved and let the show go on as booked.

The Receipts Round

- Callers — name a time a celebrity actually used their leverage for someone else instead of just posting about it.

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/or1b4cwn1aqh1

■ *Ed Sheeran's tattoo artist joins the conversation, saying that Ed Sheerans's terrible tattoos are not his fault. He says Ed Sheeran started out as a nice guy and that he is now "a lot darker"*

The Angle: *Ed Sheeran's body art is basically a running joke at this point, so when his own tattoo artist steps up to defend the ink and instead throws shade at Ed's personality, that's a gossip goldmine.*

- Ed Sheeran's **tattoo artist** spoke out, insisting the singer's infamously rough-looking tattoos are **"not his fault."**
- The artist claims Sheeran **"started out as a nice guy"** when they first worked together.
- But says Sheeran is now **"a lot darker"** - a pretty loaded quote from someone who's literally inked his skin.
- Story is circulating out of **Reddit's r/fauxmoi**, the internet's go-to for celeb tea.

The Debate Starter

- So is the tattoo artist spilling real tea on Ed Sheeran's personality, or just covering for some rough needlework?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/uuw9wsud8cqh1

■ *'Love & Hip Hop Atlanta' star detransitioning after living as a woman for 12 years: 'This isn't about erasing my past'*

The Angle: *This is a first for reality TV — the show's trailblazing transgender cast member is now opening up about detransitioning, which instantly makes it a bigger cultural conversation than just one celebrity's personal news.*

- **Smith** made history in **2016** as the first transgender cast member on VH1's **'Love & Hip Hop Atlanta.'**
- Smith lived as a woman for **12 years** before deciding to detransition.
- In announcing the change, Smith said: **"This isn't about erasing my past."**

The Debate Starter

- Detransitioning stories are rare in the public eye — what does it say that this conversation is happening on reality TV first?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/09/18/celebrity-news/love-hip-hop-atlanta-star-detransitioning-after-living-as-a-woman-for-12-years/

■ *AI-Generated 'Actress' Tilly Norwood Starts Rambling in Cantonese During Piers Morgan Interview*

The Angle: *Hollywood's controversial AI-generated actress was already a lightning rod for the 'is AI coming for actors' jobs' debate - now she's melting down live on camera, which is basically a gift for anyone skeptical this whole thing is ready for prime time.*

- **Tilly Norwood** is a fully **AI-generated 'actress'** that's been stirring up backlash across Hollywood.
- During a live interview with **Piers Morgan**, Tilly reportedly started **rambling in Cantonese** out of nowhere.
- The glitch is being widely mocked as proof the AI-actress rollout is far from polished.

The Debate Starter

- Would you trust an AI 'actress' after watching her short-circuit live on camera?

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/ai-generated-actress-tilly-norwood-starts-rambling-in-cantonese-during-piers-morgan-interview-2000814431

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Kyle Shanahan defends Sean McVay's blunder on 49ers-Rams opening season in Australia*

The Angle: *The Rams got run out of the building 27-7 by the 49ers in Australia after McVay admitted he never wanted to play there again — a Super Bowl favorite flaming out on a global stage is exactly the kind of clip the internet piles onto.*

- **Sean McVay** said he hoped the **Rams** would never have to play in **Australia** again
- **49ers** beat the **Rams 27-7** in the season-opening game in **Melbourne**
- The Rams reportedly flew into Melbourne **late**, which fed the pile-on over the blowout
- **Kyle Shanahan** publicly came to **McVay's** defense after the comments went viral

The Debate Starter

- Is McVay right to complain about the international game format, or is that just a coach making excuses for a 20-point beatdown?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/18/sports/kyle-shanahan-defends-sean-mcvays-blunder-on-49ers-rams-opening-season-in-australia/

Backup options:

■ *15 Useful Tech Devices You Can Buy for Under $50 - Lifehacker*

The Angle: *Everyone loves a good gadget, but not everyone loves the price tag - this is the 'you don't need to be rich for cool tech' story that always gets listeners texting in their own cheap-gear wins.*

- The roundup rounds up **15 gadgets**, every single one priced **under $50**
- Pitch is simple: **"high-quality tech"** doesn't require a big budget

The Phone-In Trigger

- What's the best gadget you own that cost you less than $50?

Lifehacker.com (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://lifehacker.com/tech/best-tech-devices-under-50-dollars

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■ *VIA Rail schedule changes spark backlash*

The Angle: *VIA Rail is Canada's cross-country passenger line, so when they mess with the timetable it hits travelers in multiple provinces, not just one city - that's why commuters and frequent riders are venting.*

The Phone-In Trigger

- Have VIA Rail's new schedules already messed up a trip you had planned?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMikgFBVV95cUxPZk0tX0k5UU40WVpVYTY4V3ZxV29XelItSWc5S1BMMGdUZ2xDZEVFSGM5aE5YRFU2MFRSNkN4cE9qSmxOZ3pDbnZrSVR5dk84TDR3cEhEeXBCQXZFVzFnWHloN2t1RHFHenlObkFsRmdBZXMyV09iWUpfczZtODJFU1Y4N0VadklKQlpMWnhKSUdYUQ?oc=5

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ ***Blood-Brain Barrier Successfully Repaired in Alzheimer's Models: in Alzheimer's disease, this protective border can begin to leak. The study used zebrafish, APOE4 mice, postmortem brain tissue and CSF from people with Alzheimer's, human cells, and three-dimensional blood-vessel models.***

The Angle: *Alzheimer's has always felt like a mystery with no fix in sight, but this is a genuine 'huh, that's actually hopeful' science story - researchers didn't just study the disease, they repaired a broken part of the brain in the lab.*

- The **blood-brain barrier** is the brain's protective border, and in **Alzheimer's**, it starts to spring leaks
- Researchers say they successfully **repaired** that barrier in disease models
- The study pulled from an oddly wide toolkit: **zebrafish**, **APOE4 mice**, **postmortem brain tissue**, and **cerebrospinal fluid** from real Alzheimer's patients
- They even built **3D blood-vessel models** in the lab to test the fix on human cells

The Watercooler Angle

- Everyone's got an Alzheimer's story in their family - ask listeners if a headline like this actually gives them hope or if we've heard 'breakthrough' too many times before.

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/scientists-successfully-repair-leaky-blood-brain-barrier-in-alzheimers-models

Backup options:

■ *SickKids ranked No. 1 among 250 children's hospitals worldwide*

The Angle: *A hometown hospital beating out the entire planet is an easy, feel-good brag for a Canadian audience - instant local pride with zero controversy.*

- **SickKids** (The Hospital for Sick Children, Toronto) ranked **No. 1** in the world
- It topped a field of **250** children's hospitals globally
- Puts a Canadian institution ahead of major hospitals in the **US**, **Europe**, and beyond

The Hometown Brag

- Anyone got a SickKids story - staff, patient, or family - worth sharing on air?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cp24.com/local/toronto/2026/09/17/sickkids-ranked-no-1-among-250-childrens-hospitals-worldwide/

■ *Sweden consistently outperforms Canada on universal health care despite similar spending: new study*

The Angle: *Universal healthcare is a point of national pride in Canada, so a study saying Sweden gets better outcomes for the same spending is exactly the kind of stat that makes people ask 'wait, why?' - great water-cooler fodder for a healthcare system everyone has an opinion on.*

- New study compares **Sweden** and **Canada** - both run universal health care systems
- The two countries spend roughly the **same amount** on healthcare
- Despite similar spending, **Sweden** "consistently outperforms" **Canada** on results, per the study

The Debate Starter

- If two countries spend the same on healthcare and get different results, is it the money - or the system?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nationalpost.com/news/canada/sweden-consistently-outperforms-canada-on-universal-health-care-despite-similar-spending-new-study

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CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES (franchise fallback)

■■ *More Than 23,000 Solar Panels Have Been Floating on a London Reservoir for 10 Years, Generating 5.8 Million kWh of Clean Electricity Every Year While Covering Less Than 10% of Its Surface and Helping Reduce Water Evaporation*

The Angle: *It's a decade-old fix that's still just quietly working - 23,000 panels bobbing on a reservoir, powering thousands of homes, and nobody's talking about it. Feel-good, low-key wild, and a nice palate cleanser story.*

- **23,000+ solar panels** have been floating on a London reservoir for **10 years**.
- The array generates **5.8 million kWh** of clean electricity every year.
- It covers **less than 10%** of the reservoir's surface.
- Bonus effect: it also helps **reduce water evaporation** from the reservoir.

The Feel-Good Wrap

- Ten years running and this is the first time most people are hearing about it - what other quiet wins are just floating around unnoticed?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ecoticias.com/en/floating-solar-queen-elizabeth-ii-reservoir-london/36873/

Backup options:

■ *A Lancashire company has saved 25 million LEGO bricks from landfill while making pre-owned LEGO 40–60% cheaper.*

The Angle: *A Lancashire company has saved 25 million LEGO bricks from landfill while making pre-owned LEGO 40–60% cheaper.*

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.bbc.co.uk/news/articles/c689jqvnqw9jo

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/4 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■■ *Twin sisters conjoined at the head underwent successful separation surgery*

The Angle: *Craniopagus separations are among the rarest, riskiest surgeries in medicine, and a successful one is the kind of good-news miracle story that stops people mid-scroll.*

- The sisters were **conjoined at the head** — a condition called craniopagus twins, one of the rarest forms of conjoined birth.
- Surgeons reportedly completed a **successful separation surgery**, a procedure that can take a specialized team many hours and carries major risk for both twins.

The Feel-Good Wrap

- Send us your own against-the-odds medical miracle story to close out the show.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://abcnews.com/GMA/Wellness/2-year-twins-conjoined-head-underwent-successful-separation/story?id=136489246

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)

- "The bizarre thing Nicole Kidman does to Sandra Bullock when she sees her" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-29)

- "Tiny mouse brawl breaks out on London subway platform" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Dramatic video shows naked man being pulled from East River by NYC cops" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Lady wtf, your kid is right there!" (X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful, banked 2026-09-16)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 17 banked (+15 each when found)

- "'A modern Dickie Dee bike': Sask. boy serves up sweet treats with a side of nostalgia https://t.co/tiDR4cbOP1" (X/Twitter @CTVNews, banked 2026-08-30)
- "9/11 cancers skyrocket nearly 1,700% as toxic toll on survivors surpasses first responders ahead of 25th anniversary https://t.co/HWOFfTeKZb" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-31)
- "Zendaya Rings in 30 with an Adorable Throwback Photo: 'So Much to Be Grateful for' - people.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-01)
- "Here's Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-06)
- "Rachael Leigh Cook surprises fans at 'Josie and the Pussycats' 25th anniversary screening" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-09-07)
- "Stevie Wonder Announces 'Songs in the Key of Life' 50th Anniversary Tour https://t.co/trmKJsgwqb" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Michael Goodwin: Mamdani's toxic Ground Zero blame game just latches on to still-open 9/11 wounds to boost himself" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "John Oliver to Host Comic Relief Live's 40th Anniversary Show" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Where I was on 9/11: 4 people in N.L. share their stories of stepping up to help" (www.cbc.ca, banked 2026-09-11)
- "Gander mayor reflects on 25th anniversary of 9/11" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Globe editorial: Nostalgia is no strategy for U.S. relations" (The Globe and Mail (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Universal Studios Japan Celebrates Halloween With First R-Rated Attraction" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-13)
- "'Practical Magic 2' Dazzles Up a Bit Of an Audience" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-14)
- "The London revival of "Sunday in the Park With George" has been canceled following the exits of stars Ariana Grande and Jonathan Bailey." (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "'Sunday in the Park With George' London Revival Canceled After Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey Exits https://t.co/cPQ2IIvYql" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "'Sunday in the Park With George' revival scrapped after Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey exits" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-14)
- "Margot Robbie stuns in a retro bikini as she joins shirtless Bradley Cooper to shoot the Ocean's Eleven 1960s prequel on the French Riviera" (www.dailymail.co.uk, banked 2026-09-16)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/nottheonion (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/technology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/science (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- www.dailymail.co.uk (fetch failed)
- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (fetch failed)
- @Billboard (fetch failed)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)
- 1 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

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